ZAKHEERA AI SOLUTIONS (PRIVATE) LIMITED

Exit and Resignation Procedure

Resignation, notice, clearance and final settlement

Policy ID	ZAI-HR-EX-010
Version	2.1
Effective date	1 January 2024
Policy owner	Human Resources
Applies to	All employees
Approved by	Chief Executive Officer and Head of Human Resources
HR contact	hr@zakheera.ai | Extension 2200 | HR Helpdesk on the ZakheeraHR portal

1. Purpose

This procedure explains how employees resign, notice periods, handover, clearance, final settlement and the documents they receive on leaving ZAKHEERA. It also covers termination, redundancy, retirement, and post-employment obligations.

2. How to Resign

- Submit your resignation in writing through ZakheeraHR (Exit, then Resign) and email a copy to your manager and hr@zakheera.ai.
- The resignation date is the date HR receives the written notice. The last working day is the end of the notice period.
- Your manager and HR will meet you within 3 working days to discuss your decision and the transition plan.
- Resignations can be withdrawn within 3 working days only if the Company agrees in writing.

3. Notice Periods

Employee status	Notice period (either party)
Intern / trainee	7 days
Probationary employee	14 days
Confirmed employee G2 to G4	30 days
Confirmed employee G5 and above	60 days
Contract employee	As per contract. If silent, 30 days

- Notice cannot be adjusted against annual leave, unless HR and the Department Head approve in writing.
- If the employee does not serve the full notice, the Company may recover the shortfall at one day of gross salary for each day short, from final dues (notice buyout). The Company may also waive part of the notice in writing.
- The Company may place an employee on garden leave (paid, not required to work) for part or all of the notice period if there is a conflict of interest or security risk.
- If the Company ends employment without cause, it gives the same notice or pay in lieu of notice.

4. Handover and Knowledge Transfer

During notice, the employee prepares a handover document covering active work, repositories, credentials (transferred through the password manager), client contacts, risks and pending tasks. The manager signs off the handover at least 3 working days before the last day. Code, models, datasets and documents must be pushed to Company repositories. Deleting or removing Company data is a serious offence.

5. Exit Interview

An exit interview is held with HR in the last week. It is confidential and the feedback is shared only in summarised form. A short anonymous survey is also sent. Participation helps improve the workplace but is not a condition for final settlement.

6. Clearance Checklist

Department	Items to clear
IT	Laptop, accessories, access cards, email forwarding, account deactivation on the last day, data backup confirmation
Admin	ID card, parking and building passes, locker keys, Company transport card
Finance	Loans and advances, unsettled travel claims, corporate card or petty cash
Manager	Handover sign-off, project and client transfer
HR	Leave balance, exit interview, nominee and insurance records, return of Company documents

Clearance is completed through ZakheeraHR on or before the last working day. Employees must return all Company property in working condition. Lost or damaged equipment may be charged at its depreciated value.

7. Final Settlement

The final settlement is paid within 15 working days of the last working day, after clearance is complete. It includes:

- Salary up to the last working day (pro-rata).
- Encashment of up to 10 days of unused annual leave at the daily rate (basic divided by 26).
- Gratuity, if the employee has completed 3 years (one month's last drawn basic per completed year).
- Provident fund balance, the employee's contributions and vested employer contributions (50% after 2 years, 100% after 3 years), paid within 30 days.
- Pro-rata Eid bonus where applicable and any approved claims.
- Less: notice shortfall, outstanding loans or advances, unreturned equipment charges and tax as per law.

A final settlement statement is shared with the employee, and the employee signs an acknowledgement of receipt. Annual increments, performance bonuses and the July payroll are not paid to employees who resign before 30 June, as stated in the Performance Review and Appraisal Policy.

8. Documents Issued

Document	Timing
Experience letter and relieving letter	Within 5 working days of the last day, after clearance
Tax certificate (salary withholding)	Within 15 working days, with the final settlement
Provident fund and gratuity statement	With the final settlement

Document	Timing
Employment verification for future employers	Within 3 working days of request, confirms title, dates and, with consent, salary

9. Termination, Redundancy and Retirement

- **Termination for misconduct:** After a show cause notice and inquiry as per the Employee Handbook. Gross misconduct may lead to termination without notice. Gratuity is not paid for dismissal due to gross misconduct.
- **Termination for performance:** After a PIP that is not successfully completed, with notice as per section 3.
- **Redundancy:** Employees get 30 days notice or pay in lieu, plus one month of basic salary for each year of service in addition to gratuity, with a minimum of 2 months.
- **Retirement:** Normal retirement age is 60. Early retirement is by mutual agreement. Retirees receive gratuity and provident fund as above.
- **Death in service:** Dues, gratuity, provident fund and life insurance benefit are paid to the registered nominee or legal heirs.

10. Post-Employment Obligations

- Confidentiality continues for 3 years after leaving and indefinitely for client personal data and trade secrets.
- All IP created during employment remains the property of the Company.
- Employees at G5 and above may not join a direct competitor for 6 months, or solicit clients or employees for 12 months, as per their agreement. Non-compete clauses apply only where stated in the contract and to the extent allowed by law.
- Training bond: employees who received certification or training funding of more than PKR 75,000 and leave within 12 months must repay a pro-rata share.

11. Rehire

Former employees who left in good standing may be rehired after 3 months. Service may be restored at HR discretion. Employees dismissed for gross misconduct are not eligible for rehire.

12. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What is my notice period?
A: 7 days for interns, 14 days in probation, 30 days for confirmed G2 to G4, and 60 days for G5 and above.

Q: How do I resign?
A: Submit a written resignation in ZakheeraHR under Exit, and email your manager and hr@zakheera.ai.

Q: Can I use my leaves to skip the notice period?
A: Not without written approval from HR and your Department Head.

Q: When will I receive my final settlement?
A: Within 15 working days after your last day and after clearance. The provident fund is paid within 30 days.

Q: When do I get my experience letter?
A: Within 5 working days of your last day, after clearance.

Q: Do I get gratuity if I resign after 2 years?
A: No. Gratuity needs at least 3 completed years of service.

Q: How much unused leave is encashed?

A: Up to 10 days of annual leave. Casual and sick leave are not encashed.

Q: What if I leave without serving notice?

A: The shortfall is recovered at one day of gross salary for each missing day, and may affect rehire eligibility and your relieving letter.

Q: Will I lose my bonus if I resign in June?

A: The annual bonus and increment are not paid to employees who resign before 30 June.